03 Rename columns, two ways

Give columns short, clear names with names() or with rename().

BY THE END OF THIS SECTION YOU WILL BE ABLE TO

- Rename all columns at once with names()
- Rename chosen columns with rename()
- Write new name = old name correctly

The R code in this lesson

```
# Way 1: replace all names, in order
names(demographic) <- c('Province', 'District', 'Gender', 'Marital_Status',
'HH_Size')

# Way 2: rename(new name = old name)
demographic <- demographic %>% rename("Province" = '0.1 Province Name',
                                      "District" = '0.2 District Name',
                                      "Gender" = '0.11 Sex of household head',
                                      "Marital_Status" = '0.12 Marital Status of
household head',
                                      "HH_Size" = 'HH Size')
```

What you will hear (times count from the end of the intro)

Intro Long column names like zero point eleven, sex of household head, are hard to type and easy to get wrong. In this lesson, you will learn two ways to give your columns short, clear names. Let's make our table easier to work with.

0:00 Under the note, to rename a column name, the first way uses the names function. Names of demographic, arrow, c, and then the new names in quotes, in the same order as the columns.

0:15 Province, District, Gender, Marital underscore Status, and H H underscore Size. We use underscores instead of spaces. Names without spaces are much easier to use in R.

0:33 Run it, and open the table. Look at the headers: Province, District, Gender, Marital Status, H H Size. Clean and short!

0:50 But be careful: names replaces all the names in order. If you get the order wrong, the names will be on the wrong columns.

1:15 So here is the second way, which I often prefer. I write: Or. Then I recreate the table, so we start again from the original long names.

1:40 Demographic, pipe, rename. Inside rename, we write the new name, an equals sign, and then the old name. New name first, old name second.

2:10 Province equals zero point one province name. District equals zero point two district name. Gender equals sex of household head.

2:30 Marital status, and household size, the same way. IntelliSense helps me pick each column, so the old names are spelled exactly right.

3:00 Rename only touches the columns you list, so it is safer. And the code tells everyone exactly what changed. Excellent work!